

d You mentioned that Dimension Data India has been biggest profit contributor out of the 47 countries that it has been operating in, so why retire that particular brand in this merger?

Kiran: In a world which is increasingly software-driven, where even the infrastructure services are becoming software defined and many things are off the cloud, we believe in the concept of a liquid organisation. And the whole principle of a liquid organisation is that you can now have a company where the company owns practically nothing. Even the employees can be crowd-sourced, if we are to speak to extremes. The company doesn't have to own any IT assets. Not that all companies will adopt this hybrid model, but a lot of companies are looking at a completely cloud-based model. In such an environment, companies will look at partners who have the ability to serve them without having to deal with multiple or different brands/vendors. The very fact is that we can combine the data centre hosting and cloud capabilities that NTT communications has represented, with the managed services that Dimension Data has represented, along with the software services that NTT Data represents, and then go to market as NTT, this will give the client a company whose breadth of offerings is unparalleled. There will be one single master services agreement or one single client contract and that dramatically increases the ease of doing business. So, while brands such as Dimension Data have served the company very well and has developed tremendous equity in the market, it makes sense to go into the market as a single brand.

d With larger companies you often lose the attention that smaller companies give.

Kiran: That's certainly a possibility and something that we'll have to guard ourselves against. One of the critical work-streams in the integration managed was to ensure that the entire merger process should be a non-event for the client so that they don't feel any difference. With the increased value proposition, the benefits will far outweigh any other considerations that should come into play.



Kiran Bhagwanani
CEO South Asia, NTT Ltd.

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d Before the merger happened, you had multiple companies performing R&D on similar offerings which compete against each other. How is that being resolved?

Kiran: Well, there certainly have been overlaps in the portfolio because NTT has grown organically, as well as inorganically, through acquisitions. As a result, overlaps have developed within the portfolio. With the creation of NTT Limited, there's the fact that these overlaps can be removed and the businesses can be streamlined, so this will actually help us in removing overlaps. So that the R&D investments can be streamlined and all the inefficiencies can be removed and we end up with a much more focused approach in the market.

d There was a report stating that one of the companies within the NTT umbrella was acquiring a unified license in India for telecommunications. Is that still going to be a focus for NTT to enter the telecom market again after having exited the TATA-Docomo venture?

Kiran: The Docomo business was more on the mobility side but NTT, as a global company, has been very focused on having a network or managed cloud service capability. As a global company, there are many clients who would be looking at India as one of the countries where they'd want to have managed network infrastructure and cloud services. To that extent, NTT needs to have the capabil-

ity to serve many such clients who expect NTT to step in and support the global business. Equally focused on the Indian market are NTT brands such as Dimension Data and NetMagic. So, it's important for us to have all the group capabilities in India as well. In the last three years, NTT Comms has acquired the licensing capabilities to service the clients, both nationally as well as internationally, in terms of bandwidth and telecom requirements.

d So is there a consumer-facing telecom company coming up from NTT?

Kiran: Not to my knowledge. **d**